

Emiel de Graaf

Hi there! I'm a UX Designer with 7+ years of experience who loves to dive into new challenges and turn them into user-friendly and visually appealing experiences. I have an analytical background that I like to combine with a practical approach, using qualitative and quantitative research for rapid validation and taking decisive steps to deliver real business value. Throughout this process, I proactively involve developers, stakeholders, and other disciplines to create alignment and bring everything together.

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Education:

MSc Information Studies

University of Amsterdam, 2017 — 2018

Track: Human Centred Multimedia

GPA: 7,7

BSc Information Science

University of Amsterdam, 2013 — 2016

GPA: 8,3

Skills:

UX/UI Design

Product Design, Visual, Design Systems, Accessibility (WCAG), Figma, etc.

User Research & Analytics

Qualitative Research, CRO & A/B Testing, Google Analytics, Hotjar, Lyssna, Optimizely, etc.

Service Design & Strategy

Customer Journeys, Service Blueprints, Product Strategy, Assumption Mapping, Miro, etc.

AI Tools

Figma Make, Claude Code, AI for Synthesis (Google NotebookLM, ChatGPT), etc.

Agile Development

Product Strategy, KPIs, Scrum & Agile, Product Owner Experience, Leading Refinements, etc.

Organizational Alignment

Stakeholder Management, Presenting, Workshop Facilitation, Cross-functional Collaboration, etc.

Experience:



Intergamma (via Saxum)

UX Designer, Mar 2026 — Present

As an Interim Senior UX Designer at Intergamma, I focus on optimizing the digital experiences for the major DIY retail brands GAMMA and KARWEI across both web and mobile platforms. I own the design strategy for the discovery journey, streamlining the end-to-end process to help users effortlessly find the right products for their home improvement projects. Working in close collaboration with the CRO team, I continuously deliver data-driven design improvements aimed at boosting user retention and conversion rates. Furthermore, I am developing a scalable design system to strengthen collaboration between design and development, reducing overall complexity while driving platform-wide consistency.



Saxum

Senior UX Designer, Feb 2026 — Present

As a Senior Designer at Saxum, I work on an interim basis for various organizations, quickly embedding into cross-functional teams to tackle complex digital challenges.



CPM Europe (Freelance Project)

UX/Service Designer, Aug 2025 — March 2026

As a freelance designer, I helped CPM Europe, an international machine manufacturer, improve their Economic Die Life application—a tool designed to help pellet machine operators predict the optimal timing for replacing parts. The application represented a first step in a broader mission to digitize their operations.

I conducted an expert review of the software and facilitated journey-mapping sessions with R&D stakeholders to evaluate the tool against operator workflows. I then conducted qualitative interviews with international clients to deeply validate user needs, translating these into tangible insights and conceptual designs that successfully reshaped the product roadmap.



DPG Media

UI/UX Designer, Jun 2024 — Jan 2026

As a designer at DPG Media, I was part of a large UX team and product development team, working on the design of a white-label app and website for 15+ of the largest Dutch and Belgian news brands, including de Volkskrant, Het Parool, and AD. One of the projects I worked on was the design of a scalable system that allowed individual newsrooms to create their own visual stories, enabling visual storytelling in a uniform way across all brands. These stories resulted in a **+28% increase** in user engagement.

Throughout this process, I mapped out editorial workflows, conducted continuous qualitative research and CRO experiments, and leveraged AI tools for rapid prototyping and synthesis. I actively facilitated cross-functional workshops, aligned complex stakeholder landscapes, and ensured the platform was accessible and WCAG 2.1 compliant.



FD Mediagroep

UX Designer & Interim Product Owner, Feb 2021 — Jun 2024

As a UX Designer at FD Mediagroep, I collaborated within a compact, agile team to enhance the reading and listening experiences for Het Financieele Dagblad and BNR Nieuwsradio. I owned the end-to-end design process, independently driving qualitative discovery, rapid prototyping, and user validation. Furthermore, I facilitated weekly alignment with cross-functional stakeholders and served as an interim Product Owner for three months.

As a designer, I led the redesign of the BNR app—leveraging user reviews to simplify the podcast experience and boost engagement by **+47% in monthly sessions**. For Het Financieele Dagblad, I established a multiplatform design system to unify development, and designed an article-gifting feature that resolved a critical sharing friction point, reaching **10,000 active subscribers** per month.

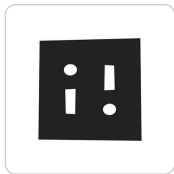


Makelaarsland

UX Designer, Mar 2019 — Oct 2020

At Makelaarsland, I drove omnichannel user experiences and conversion optimization across the customer portal, public website, and mobile app. I mapped the end-to-end sales journey for home sellers, translating user friction points into targeted design improvements. To maximize business impact, I analyzed onboarding and lead generation funnels via Google Analytics, addressing drop-off points and validating design solutions through data-driven A/B testing.

In this role, I collaborated closely with the internal development team, marketing, and an external web agency. I partnered with the front office to convert direct customer feedback into actionable design proposals, and contributed strategically to defining the communication for Makelaarsland's premium real estate proposition.



Informaat (Master's Thesis Internship)

UX Designer, Apr 2018 — Aug 2018

As a Graduate UX Intern for my Master's thesis at Informaat, I designed an intuitive conversational UX/UI framework for a self-service e-commerce chatbot. To improve user guidance and manage expectations, I mapped the entire conversational flow—including fallbacks and visual interface components—and built a functional prototype using Google Dialogflow. Through three iterations of usability testing with 15 participants, I validated design patterns like predefined quick-replies, ultimately presenting my findings and framework in a comprehensive report to share conversational design best practices across the internal agency team.



Quo Vide

Front-End Developer, Dec 2016 — Jul 2017



Web First

Front-End Developer, Jan 2016 — Aug 2016